

Setup Guide: Connecting Your Free AI Key

How to get QuotePilot's "Extract scope" feature working in about 5 minutes, for \$0.

QuotePilot's AI scope-extraction runs on your own account with OpenRouter, a free gateway to dozens of AI models. This means the feature costs nothing to use — you're not paying QuotePilot or Anthropic per quote, and there's no subscription. You do this setup once; after that, QuotePilot just works.

Step-by-step

1

Create a free OpenRouter account

Go to openrouter.ai and click Sign Up. You can sign up with Google or GitHub in a few seconds — no credit card required.

2

Generate an API key

Once logged in, go to your account settings and find the "Keys" section. Click "Create Key," give it any name (e.g. "QuotePilot"), and click Create.

A key will appear starting with `sk-or-v1-`. Click to copy it — you'll paste this into QuotePilot in Step 4.

Tip: Treat this key like a password. Don't share it or post it publicly.

3

Pick a free model

QuotePilot comes pre-set to a free model, so you can usually skip this step entirely.

If you ever want to change it: visit openrouter.ai/models, and look for models with `:"free"` at the end of their name (for example, models from Nvidia, Meta, or Google's free tiers). Copy the exact model name shown on that page.

Tip: Free models are occasionally renamed or retired. If extraction ever stops working, this is the first place to check.

4

Paste your key into QuotePilot

Open QuotePilot and click "Settings" in the top right.

Paste your API key into the "OpenRouter API key" field. Leave the Model field as-is unless you changed it in Step 3.

Click "Save settings."

5**Test it**

Start a new quote, type a sample job description (e.g. "Need a bathroom faucet replaced"), and click "Extract scope."

If everything is set up correctly, a scope list will appear within a few seconds — you're done.

If something goes wrong

"Add your free OpenRouter API key" error

This means Settings doesn't have a key saved yet, or it wasn't saved. Go to Settings, re-enter the key, and click "Save settings" again.

"Request failed (401)"

Your API key wasn't accepted — usually a copy-paste issue (an extra space, or a missing character). Go back to openrouter.ai, copy the key again carefully, and re-save it in Settings.

"Request failed (404)" or "No response text returned"

The model name may no longer exist — free models are occasionally renamed. Go to openrouter.ai/models, find a current model ending in ":free", and paste its exact name into the Model field in Settings.

Nothing happens when you click "Extract scope"

Check that you actually typed something into the job description field first — the button won't do anything on an empty field.

Frequently asked questions

Is this actually free, forever?

Yes, as long as you stick to a model with ":free" in its name. OpenRouter's free models have no cost and no hidden usage fees. If you ever choose a paid model instead, OpenRouter will show its per-use price clearly before you switch to it.

Does QuotePilot ever see my API key?

No. Your key is stored only in your own browser (on your own computer) and is sent directly from your browser to OpenRouter when you use the feature. It never passes through QuotePilot's creators.

Can I use a different AI provider instead of OpenRouter?

The Settings screen is built specifically for OpenRouter's free tier to keep this at zero cost. If you want to use a different provider, that would require a small code change rather than a Settings change.

What if I want a smarter (paid) model later?

You can switch anytime — just replace the Model field in Settings with a paid model's name from openrouter.ai/models. Paid usage is billed by OpenRouter directly to the payment method you add to your own account.